

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**JOIN OBOR
... A VIEW**

MINI CAPSULE

11-05-2017

7/19th Week

CURRENT AFFAIRS



BELT AND ROAD INITIATIVE & INDIA



18th WEEK 2017

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

1st May to 7th May



GENESIS OF THE ISSUE



- 1 The BRI originated from two speeches by the President Xi Jinping in Central Asia in 2013.
- 2 The outline plans for China's **global outreach through connectivity** and infrastructure development.
- 3 On March 17, this year, the United Nations Security Council(UNSC) adopted a resolution on security in Afghanistan.
- 4 The above resolution includes a reference to regional development initiatives such as the **China's BRI**.
- 5 China promptly announced that this reference (probably inserted at its instance) reflected a global consensus on the BRI.
- 6 China is going to host BRI Summit in May 2017.
- 7 The declared purpose is to review the progress of BRI and obtain perspectives of stake holders and plan new trajectories for cooperation.



1

SILK ROAD - ECONOMIC BELT

It includes land corridors from China through Central Asia and Russia to Europe, which include spurs to West Asia and to Pakistan, i.e CPEC.

2

21st CENTURY MARITIME SILK ROAD

It links China's east coast through major sea lanes to Europe in the west and Pacific in the east.

*Together they constitute BRI or Belt and Road Initiative.
Originally the name was One Belt and One Road.*



CAN CHINA ADDRESS INDIA'S GENUINE CONCERNS?



Xi Jinping,
President of China



Narendra Modi
Prime Minister of India

ALREADY PROBLEMATIC ISSUES

- China's position on NSG.
- Arunachal Pradesh issue.
- Masood Azhar issue
- Stapled visas
- Objection to Dalai Lama's visit
- Changing the maps/ names of the places showing Arunachal Pradesh as part of China.

BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



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NEWS REPORT

- 1 China is conducting BRI Forum in Beijing on May 14.
- 2 28 leaders are participating and 110 nations sending their representatives.

There is a view for joining India in BRI, but the sovereignty issues still remain. Here a view is presented for India to join OBOR.



BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



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POINT NO: 1

- India's response should be based on its long-term interests.
- Short-term concerns should not be the reason.
- BRI already has contracts of over \$1 trillion covering over 60 countries.
- It is increasing areas of cooperation among the countries.
- India can join and push for the southern node and a 'Digital Asia'.
- India cannot be a \$10 trillion economy by 2032 without integrating itself with the growing Asian markets.
- It is also essential to link its supply, manufacturing and market networks.

BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



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POINT NO: 2

- It is essential to develop common standards with the fastest growing economies in Asia.
- Most important is Bangladesh, Vietnam and Indonesia to facilitate trade, investment and business engagement.
- India joining OBOR will also benefit India to develop market linkages.



BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



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POINT NO: 3

- OBOR offers a new cooperation framework in South Asia to face global challenges.
- They can be in the areas of sharing meteorological reports, region specific climate research, Aadhaar digital experience etc.
- Security concerns can also be addressed.



POINT NO: 4

- Thought leadership provides an avenue to increasing global influence.
- Hinduism and Buddhism spread to East and South-East Asia with commerce.
- Shared prosperity should be the new mantra in the 21st Century.
- Same principle dominated till 1800 making India, the world's richest country for over two millennia.



BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



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POINT NO: 5

- Countries are now gaining influence more through the strength of their economy than the might of the military.
- India still sees the re-emergence of China through a security prism.
- Now the situation, calls for new alliances with Iran, Iraq, and Afghanistan to create a two-front dilemma for our western neighbour.
- Almost, all countries in Asia, except Japan, embraced the BRI initiative.

India requires new approaches to secure our own re-emergence.



BRI FORUM ... A VIEW FOR INDIA TO JOIN



POINT NO: 6

- China is knitting together the Asian market with roads, rail, ports and fibre optics.
- As the world economy is expected to triple by 2050, Asia will have half of global wealth.
- China is seeking to fill the vacuum following the U.S withdrawal from the Trans-Pacific Partnership.
- India should not sit idle.



***India should also make the move to become part of the
'Asian Century'.***

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